

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

FEDERAL SHUTDOWN

Thune rejects offer on impasse

Schumer's proposal for health subsidies deemed 'nonstarter'

By Mary Clare Jalonick
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Senate Majority Leader John Thune quickly swatted down a Democratic offer to reopen the government and extend expiring health care subsidies for a year, calling it a “nonstarter” as the partisan impasse over the shutdown continued into its 38th day.

Senate Democratic Leader Chuck Schumer made the offer to reopen the government on Friday as Republicans have refused to negotiate on their demands to extend health care subsidies. It was a much narrowed version of a broad proposal Democrats laid out a month ago to make the health tax credits permanent and reverse Medicaid cuts that Republicans enacted earlier this year.

Schumer offered Republicans simultaneous votes to end the government shutdown and extend the expiring health care subsidies, along with a bipartisan committee to address Republican demands for changes to the Affordable Care Act.

“All Republicans have to do is say yes,” Schumer said.

But Republicans quickly said no, and Thune reiterated that they would not trade offers on health care until the government is reopened. “That’s

Turn to Shutdown, Page 8

■ Cancellations pile up at Chicago airports, with more on the way. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

■ SNAP funds begin to be disbursed in some states, but Trump takes appeal to Supreme Court. **Nation & World**

Moody Bible files lawsuit against CPS alleging bias

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Moody Bible Institute is suing the Chicago Board of Education for alleged religious discrimination after the college was barred from the district’s student teaching program.

The Christian college alleges Chicago Public Schools will not allow it to participate in the program unless it signs the district’s nondiscrimination policy, which goes against its doctrinal statement, according to a complaint filed Tuesday in federal court in Chicago.

The complaint was filed on Moody’s behalf by the Alliance Defending Freedom, a conservative Christian law firm and advocacy group.

“Chicago desperately needs more teachers to fill hundreds of vacancies, but public school administrators are putting personal agendas ahead of the needs of families,” attorney Jeremiah Galus said in a statement.

CPS requires all contractors and employees to abide by its nondiscrimination policy, which includes protections

Turn to Moody, Page 5

Judge eyes Broadview visit

Magistrate: Planned trip to suburban ICE facility critical amid allegations of inhumane conditions

By Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

A federal magistrate said she plans to visit the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement processing center in Broadview amid a class-action lawsuit alleging inhumane conditions, grant-

ing a win to the plaintiffs who want verification that the government is abiding by court-ordered requirements to improve circumstances there.

Magistrate Laura McNally made her intentions known during a Friday afternoon hearing that followed a status report filed

earlier in the day in which the government said it was in compliance or working to comply with a series of requirements ordered by a judge to make the facility livable and humane, even as the plaintiffs expressed skepticism and asked for proof.

U.S. District Judge Robert Gettleman on Wednesday issued a temporary restraining order that requires government officials to provide immigration detainees

with enough food, water and bed space, among other remedies.

“It has really become a prison,” Gettleman said on Tuesday. “The conditions would be found unconstitutional even in the context of prisons holding convicted felons, but these are not convicted felons. These are civil detainees.”

Assistant U.S. Attorney Jana Brady noted that Gettleman

Turn to Broadview, Page 5



E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

14 moms arrested at sit-in

Police arrested 14 mothers outside the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement processing center in Broadview on Friday morning in the latest act of civil disobedience at the facility that’s become a flash point of opposition to the Trump administration’s Operation Midway Blitz. As police began to process the arrests, another woman grabbed a megaphone and yelled that the sit-in participants were exercising their First Amendment rights. “Stop abducting our community members,” she said. “Stop separating families.” **Chicagoland, Page 2**



She ‘belongs at home,’ says attorney for day care worker arrested by ICE

An attorney representing the day care teacher arrested by federal immigration agents at a Chicago preschool said Friday that his client is currently detained at an ICE facility in Clark County, Indiana, but that she “belongs at home.” Diana Santillana Galeano was arrested Wednesday morning at the Rayito de Sol Spanish Immersion Early Learning Center in North Center, sparking outrage from parents and staff who knew the 38-year-old as someone who went “above and beyond” for the school. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

‘HOW CAN WE HELP?’

This is how the staff at Chappell Elementary School in Lincoln Square found out one of their families had been torn apart.

A fourth-grade girl was in the lunchroom when she began to cry. School workers called for a counselor, and the student told them that her father had been arrested by immigration agents.

Teachers reached out to the child’s mother, Ingrid Guanume, who told them federal immigration agents had taken her husband, Brayan Plata, Wednesday while working at his landscaping job in Skokie. Guanume and Plata live in the Albany Park neighborhood with a newborn, a 5-year-old autistic preschooler and their older daughter.

The loss has unsettled their family, Guanume said. She and her husband are Colombians seeking asylum. They arrived in Chicago in 2018. The U.S. Department of Homeland Security released a statement accusing him of overstaying a visa “by more than six years.” Guanume said her husband has a license and work permit.

“He’s the one who works, who takes care of his three children,” Guanume told the Tribune.

What happened next is a familiar sequence of events since President

Lincoln Square school rallies around family after ICE takes parent of special needs child

By Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune



Ingrid Guanume’s husband, Brayan Plata, was detained by federal immigration enforcement officers while working as a landscaper in Skokie on Thursday. The community has rallied around Guanume and Plata, who live in the Albany Park neighborhood with a newborn, a 5-year-old autistic preschooler and their older daughter. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Donald Trump launched Operation Midway Blitz, a wave of immigration raids the administration originally said was targeted at “the worst of the worst” but has expanded to pursue as many immigrants without permanent legal status as possible.

The community sprung into action. Two parents at the school, Audra Wunder and Erin Tobes, who have been leading safety efforts through the Parent-Teacher Organization began asking basic questions.

“Does she need food? Does she need clothing?” Tobes recalled. “People immediately (responded), How can we help? How can we help? We set up a GoFundMe knowing we will have legal fees ... We were able to collect groceries, diapers, wipes.”

When the women delivered the goods to the family Thursday night, Tobes thanked the little girl for alerting the school.

“You’re so brave to reach out and ask for help for your mom,” Tobes told her.

The girl teared up. “I said, ‘We’re here to help no matter what,’” Wunder said. “If you need something, reach out.”

Turn to Help, Page 2

